Ayutthaya in April 1760. The Burmese advanced to the outskirts of the city on April 11, 1760, but never laid siege to Ayutthaya. For reasons unknown, Alaùngpayà began a sudden retreat from Ayutthaya toward Martaban but died en route on May 11, 1760, in the village of Kinywa. Sources differ on the reasons for Alaùngpayà's retreat from Ayutthaya. Siamese sources suggest that Alaùngpayà was wounded by an exploding shell from a siege gun, while Burmese sources state that he died from dysentery. Whatever his malady, the condition was most likely the reason behind the sudden withdrawal.

Alaùngpayà's eldest son Naungdawgi (r. ca. 1760–1763) succeeded his father. Most of Naungdawgi brief reign was spent suppressing two major rebellions. His untimely death in 1763 allowed his younger brother Hsinbyushin (r. ca. 1763–1776) to ascend to the throne. Hsinbyushin, a seasoned military commander, launched a classic pincer movement against Ayutthaya in September 1765. One force attacked Chiang Mai and Vientiane before invading the Chao Phraya River valley and then attacking Ayutthaya from the north. A second force attacked from the south. Ayutthaya finally fell on April 28, 1767, three years after the operation's inception. The victory was short-lived as the governor of Tak province of Siam, Taksin (r. ca. 1767–1782), soon expelled Hsinbyushin's armies from cities along the east coast of the Gulf of Siam. In October 1767, Taksin took the port of Thonburi on the west bank of Chao Phraya River. He used Thonburi as the base for defeating the Hsinbyushin's invading army and declaring himself king of Siam.

THE SINO-BURMESE CONFLICT (1765–1789)

The greatest threat to Hsinbyushin's power came from the Chinese vis-à-vis the Shan principalities who viewed Burmese incursions into the Shan plateau and the Menam valley with suspicion. The Shan principalities served as a buffer between Burma and the Chinese province of Yunnan, with Shan rulers paying tribute to one or both powers. What ostensibly began as conflict of a Shan hereditary local chieftain (saw-bwa) over suzerainty of Kengtung broke out into open warfare that engulfed the entire border region. Conflict between China and Burma was averted until December 1765, when Hsinbyushin dispatched his armies from Ava to expel a Yunnanese expeditionary force from Kengtung and restore a